(Don't Write
anything in this Area)

- Q7. (a) Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage in the world and also give anthropological interpretations of live in relationships. (20 marks)

With the globalised and materialised living rising in the world, there has been a decline in the marriage institution.

Factors responsible:

- ① Economic cost: The cost of starting families in cities like New York very high due to higher cost of living. Thus, the economic cost acts as barrier to marriage.
- ② Shoulder responsibility: Marriage comes with a lot of responsibility which the current generation is unwilling to shoulder.
- ③ Lack of social control: In the modern materialized world, there is a lack of

social pressure to marry thus resulting in decline of marriage.

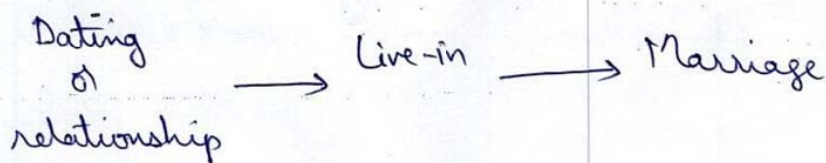
④ Perceived lack of freedom: Marriage is seen as a life-long commitment thus resulting in lack of freedom. This results in decline of marriage.

⑤ Feminist movements: The rise of feminist movements threw light on the rights of women who are now unwilling to compromise thus resulting in decline of marriage.

⑥ Legal hurdles: With the rise of acceptance of homosexuality, there is no corresponding rise in legal acceptance thus resulting in hurdles of marriage of homosexual people.

Anthropological interpretation of live-ins:

- (i) Live-in relationship is where a couple live together having all features of a marriage but ~~do~~ are not formally tied by bond of marriage.
- (ii) Live-in relationships are a household group with economic and sexual relations.
- (iii) They are seen an avenue for couples who do not want to enter the commitment of marriage.
- (iv) In the Western world, live-in relationships actually got normalized and are seen as a ~~a~~ step before marriage.



- (v) Live-in relationships are seen as a test to see the compatibility of the

couple and this might lead to stability in marriages.

Thus, live-in relationships are seen as new type of quasi-familial relationships that act as a step before marriage giving the couple time and space to decide upon the next step of marriage.